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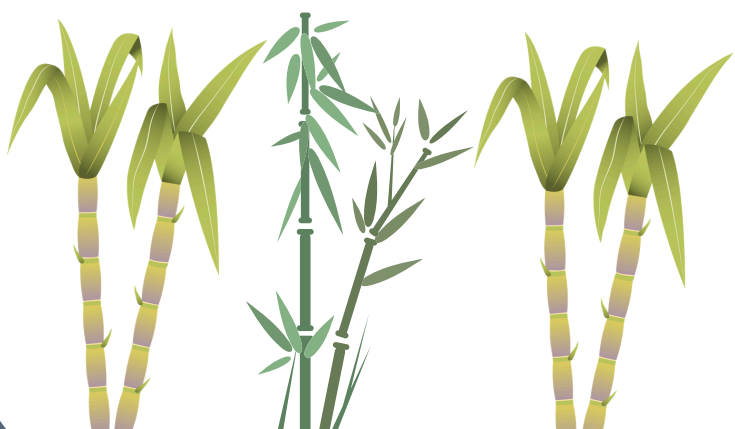
Fortune Institute of International Business (FIIB)
New Delhi

Individual Assignment

# Qualitative Analysis of Consumer Perceptions Toward Packaged Sugarcane Juice

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# 01 | Introduction

The beverage market is highly affected by health awareness, convenience and brand trust as consumers seek to determine their preferences. Common drinks include sugarcane juice which is widely used in India as it brings freshness, natural form and freshness. The idea of packaged sugarcane juice however brings new factors into consideration when it comes to product authenticity, preservatives and hygiene as well as a brand reliability.

This research is aimed at examining consumer perception of packaged sugarcane juice through qualitative research methods. Two consumer interview transcripts were examined in order to reveal primary themes which affected the consumer attitudes and purchase intentions. The research will seek to comprehend the role played by the factors in the perception of health, authenticity of the product, brand trust, convenience, packaging quality, and perceived risks in influencing consumer decision-making.

The results are useful to companies that intend to launch packaged sugarcane juice in the market because they will have a better idea on the expectations and concerns of consumers.

# 02 | Research Methodology

This paper utilizes the qualitative approach to research in order to examine how consumers view packaged sugarcane juice. Two interview transcripts were studied with the help of QDA Miner Lite software. The transcripts were taken in the software and analyzed with the help of open coding.

In the analysis, significant portions of the interview transcripts were determined and given descriptive codes that depicted major concepts expressed by the respondents. The transcripts produced 26 open codes. The frequency of codes was used to determine the most prominent patterns in the data.

The open codes were created and the similar codes were categorized into broader thematic groups. These themes served to classify the data and find out the key factors affecting consumer perceptions and intentions to buy. The thematic analysis method enabled the researcher to give a systematic meaning to the qualitative data and come up with insights with the direct quotes of the interview transcripts.

# 03 | Open Coding Table

The open coding process generated multiple codes representing the key ideas identified in the transcripts. The following table presents the codes and the number of segments associated with each code.

| Category | Code | Description | Count | % Codes | Cases | % Cases |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Product authenticity | Traditional beverage perception | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Purchase drivers | Brand trust | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Purchase drivers | Convenience importance | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Purchase drivers | Convenience of packaged drinks | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Purchase intention | Recommendation intention | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| consumption habits | Daily baverage consumption | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Purchase drivers | Price sensitivity | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Product authenticity | Natural preparation | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Product authenticity | Freshness perception | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Health perception | Health benefit expectation | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Health perception | Healthy lifestyle orientation | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Health perception | Healthier than packaged drinks | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Purchase drivers | Product availability | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Purchase drivers | Information evaluation | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Health perception | Natural beverage preference | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Product quality | Taste authenticity concern | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Product perception | Refreshment perception | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Consumption pattern | Seasonal consumption | | 1 | 2.7% | 1 | 50.0% |
| Health benefits | Natural energy benefit | | 2 | 5.4% | 2 | 100.0% |
| Sustainability perception | Eco friendly packaging | | 2 | 5.4% | 2 | 100.0% |
| Purchase intention | Trial intention | | 2 | 5.4% | 2 | 100.0% |
| Purchase drivers | Convenience preference | | 2 | 5.4% | 2 | 100.0% |
| Risk perception | Preservative concern | | 2 | 5.4% | 2 | 100.0% |
| Product quality | Packaging hygiene | | 2 | 5.4% | 2 | 100.0% |
| Risk perception | Freshness concern | | 2 | 5.4% | 2 | 100.0% |
| Purchase drivers | Brand credibility | | 2 | 5.4% | 2 | 100.0% |
| Health perception | Health concern | | 3 | 8.1% | 2 | 100.0% |

According to the coding findings, health concern, convenience preference, preservative concern, brand credibility, and natural energy benefit are more common implying that these variables are important determinants of consumer perceptions.

# 04 | Thematic Categorization and Key Factors

The open codes were grouped into broader themes to better understand consumer perceptions regarding packaged sugarcane juice.

## Theme 1: Health Perception and Benefits

**Key Factor 1: Health-Conscious Beverage Choices**

**Related Codes**

- Health concern
- Healthy lifestyle orientation
- Natural beverage preference
- Health benefit expectation
- Healthier than packaged drinks

**Description**

Consumers show strong health awareness when choosing beverages. The respondents expressed a preference for natural and nutritious drinks while avoiding beverages perceived as unhealthy. Sugarcane juice is viewed as a healthier alternative compared to carbonated drinks and many packaged beverages.

**Supporting Quote**

"I avoid carbonated drinks because I feel they are unhealthy."

**Key Factor 2: Energy and Refreshment Benefits**

**Related Codes**

- Natural energy benefit
- Refreshment perception

**Description**

Sugarcane juice is widely perceived as a refreshing drink that provides instant energy. This perception strengthens the positive image of the beverage, particularly during hot weather conditions.

**Supporting Quote** "It's very refreshing, and I feel it gives instant energy."

## Theme 2: Product Authenticity

**Key Factor: Freshness and Natural Preparation**

**Related Codes**

- Freshness perception
- Natural preparation
- Traditional beverage perception

**Description**

Consumers strongly associate sugarcane juice with freshness and natural preparation. Since traditional sugarcane juice is extracted in front of the consumer, packaged versions raise questions about whether the same level of authenticity and freshness can be maintained.

**Supporting Quote**

"I associate sugarcane juice with natural freshness because it is prepared in front of you."

## Theme 3: Purchase Drivers

**Key Factor 1: Brand Trust**

**Related Codes**

- Brand credibility
- Information evaluation

**Description**

Brand reputation plays a crucial role in influencing consumer purchase decisions. Consumers are more willing to try packaged sugarcane juice if it is introduced by a well-known brand that ensures product quality and hygiene.

**Supporting Quote** "I trust established brands because they follow quality standards."

**Key Factor 2: Convenience and Availability**

**Related Codes**

- Convenience preference
- Convenience importance
- Convenience of packaged drinks
- Product availability

**Description**

Convenience is a major factor influencing beverage consumption. Packaged beverages provide flexibility and accessibility, particularly for consumers with busy lifestyles. This convenience increases the likelihood of purchasing packaged sugarcane juice.

**Supporting Quote**

"Packaged beverages are easy to store and consume anytime."

**Key Factor 3: Price Sensitivity**

**Related Codes**

- Price sensitivity

**Description**

Consumers consider pricing when evaluating packaged beverages. Affordable pricing relative to other packaged juices increases the likelihood of consumers trying the product.

**Supporting Quote**

"If the price is reasonable compared to other packaged juices, I would be willing to try it."

## Theme 4: Product Quality and Packaging

**Key Factor 1: Packaging Quality**

**Related Codes**

- Packaging hygiene
- Eco friendly packaging

**Description**

Packaging plays a crucial role in shaping consumer perceptions of product quality and safety. Hygienic and professional packaging increases consumer confidence and improves the product's image.

**Supporting Quote**

"Packaging should look hygienic, attractive, and professional."

**Key Factor 2: Taste Authenticity**

**Related Codes**

- Taste authenticity concern

**Description**

Consumers worry that packaged sugarcane juice may not replicate the authentic taste of freshly prepared juice. This concern may influence their willingness to purchase packaged versions.

**Supporting Quote**

"Fresh sugarcane juice has a unique taste."

## Theme 5: Risk Perception

**Key Factor: Freshness and Preservative Concerns**

**Related Codes**

- Preservative concern
- Freshness concern

**Description**

Consumers express concerns about preservatives and the potential loss of freshness in packaged sugarcane juice. These perceived risks can act as barriers to adoption of the packaged product.

**Supporting Quote**

"I worry that preservatives may affect taste and health benefits."

## Theme 6: Purchase Intention

**Key Factor: Trial and Recommendation**

**Related Codes**

- Trial intention
- Recommendation intention

**Description**

Despite some concerns, consumers demonstrate willingness to try packaged sugarcane juice if it meets quality expectations and is offered by trusted brands.

**Supporting Quote**

"I would consider trying it if launched by a trusted brand."

# 05 | Conceptual Framework

The conceptual framework shows what are the influences that will have a significant impact on consumer purchase intention towards packaged sugarcane juice. The thematic analysis of the interview transcripts done with QDA Miner Lite results in the framework. The qualitative results also show that there is a series of perceptual and evaluative processes that affect consumer buying behaviors.




Figure 1: Conceptual Framework of Consumer Decision-Making for Packaged Sugarcane Juice

The framework is structured as a consumer decision funnel where multiple factors progressively influence the consumer's evaluation process before leading to purchase intention.

At the first stage, **health awareness** plays a significant role in shaping consumer preferences. Consumers increasingly prefer natural and healthy beverages and tend to avoid carbonated or artificial drinks. As a result, sugarcane juice is perceived positively due to its natural composition and refreshing properties.

The second stage involves **product authenticity**. Consumers associate sugarcane juice with freshness and traditional preparation methods. The transition to packaged products creates uncertainty regarding whether the same level of freshness and natural quality can be maintained.

The third stage highlights the importance of **brand trust**. Consumers demonstrate greater willingness to try packaged sugarcane juice when it is offered by established and reputable brands that maintain quality standards and hygienic production practices.

Next, **convenience and price considerations** influence consumer evaluation. Packaged beverages offer accessibility and ease of consumption, particularly for individuals with busy lifestyles. At the same time, consumers evaluate whether the price is reasonable compared to other packaged beverages.

The fifth stage involves **risk perception**, particularly concerns related to preservatives, freshness, and taste authenticity. Consumers may hesitate to purchase packaged sugarcane juice if they believe it may compromise the natural taste or health benefits of the beverage.

Finally, these factors collectively lead to **purchase intention**, where consumers decide whether they are willing to try or recommend packaged sugarcane juice. The framework illustrates that purchase intention is influenced by a combination of health perception, product authenticity, brand credibility, convenience, pricing, and perceived risks.

# 06 | Managerial Implications

The findings of this qualitative analysis provide important insights into consumer perceptions toward packaged sugarcane juice. The thematic analysis identified several key factors that influence consumer attitudes and purchase intentions, including health perception, product authenticity, brand trust, convenience, packaging quality, and perceived risks.

One of the most significant findings is the strong influence of **health awareness** on beverage choices. Consumers increasingly prefer beverages that are perceived as natural and beneficial for health. Sugarcane juice is widely associated with natural ingredients and refreshing energy, which enhances its positive perception among consumers. This indicates that companies introducing packaged sugarcane juice should emphasize the natural and healthy characteristics of the product in their marketing strategies.

Another important factor influencing consumer perception is **product authenticity**. Consumers strongly associate sugarcane juice with freshness and traditional preparation methods. The idea of packaged sugarcane juice raises concerns about whether the same level of freshness and natural taste can be maintained. Therefore, companies should focus on communicating how the product preserves the natural taste and freshness of freshly extracted sugarcane juice.

The analysis also highlights the importance of **brand trust** in consumer decision-making. Consumers demonstrate greater willingness to try packaged sugarcane juice when it is produced by established and reputable brands. Trusted brands are perceived as more reliable in terms of product safety, hygiene, and quality standards. This suggests that strong brand positioning and credibility are essential for gaining consumer acceptance.

**Convenience and price considerations** also influence purchase decisions. Packaged beverages offer accessibility and ease of consumption, particularly for consumers with busy lifestyles. However, consumers still evaluate the price of the product relative to other packaged beverages before making a purchase decision. Competitive pricing strategies may therefore increase the likelihood of trial and adoption.

Finally, **risk perception** plays a critical role in shaping consumer attitudes toward packaged sugarcane juice. Concerns regarding preservatives, freshness, and taste authenticity may discourage some consumers from purchasing the product. Companies should address these concerns by providing clear labeling, emphasizing natural ingredients, and ensuring hygienic packaging.

Overall, the findings suggest that companies planning to introduce packaged sugarcane juice should focus on maintaining product authenticity, building strong brand credibility, offering convenient packaging, and clearly communicating the health benefits of the product.

# 07 | Conclusion

This study explored consumer perceptions toward packaged sugarcane juice using qualitative analysis of interview transcripts. The analysis identified several key factors influencing consumer attitudes and purchase intentions, including health perception, product authenticity, brand trust, convenience, packaging quality, and perceived risk.

The findings indicate that consumers view sugarcane juice as a natural and refreshing beverage that provides health benefits and energy. However, the introduction of packaged sugarcane juice raises concerns regarding freshness, preservatives, and taste authenticity. These concerns may affect consumer willingness to adopt packaged versions of the product.

Brand trust and convenience were identified as important drivers of purchase intention. Consumers are more likely to try packaged sugarcane juice if it is offered by trusted brands that maintain high quality standards and hygienic packaging. Competitive pricing and easy availability may further encourage consumer adoption.

The study highlights that companies introducing packaged sugarcane juice should focus on communicating the product's natural ingredients, maintaining freshness, and building strong brand credibility. By addressing consumer concerns and emphasizing convenience and health benefits, companies can improve consumer acceptance and increase the likelihood of successful market introduction.

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